Library and Computing Labs Usage Policy 2026

Synthetic sample policy for a fictional university.

1. Scope

This policy applies to all students, staff and visitors using the Northfield University libraries and computing labs. A valid university ID card is required to borrow items and to enter the labs.

2. Borrowing limits

Undergraduate students may borrow up to **12 items** at a time, postgraduate students up to **25 items** and staff up to **40 items**. Visitors with a reference pass may use materials in the building but may not borrow.

3. Loan periods

Standard loans last **21 days**. Items on course reserve are **short loans** of four hours and must be returned to the service desk. Popular items may be marked as seven-day loans. A loan may be renewed up to three times online, unless another reader has placed a hold on the item.

4. Fines, Lost Items and Account Blocks

4.1 Overdue fines

Overdue standard loans are charged **0.50 per day**, up to a maximum of 15.00 per item. Overdue short loans are charged **1.00 per hour**, up to a maximum of 10.00 per item, because other students are waiting for them.

4.2 Lost and damaged items

An item more than 60 days overdue is treated as lost. The borrower is charged the replacement cost plus a **processing fee of 10.00**. If the item is later returned in good condition, the replacement cost is refunded but the processing fee is not.

4.3 Account blocks

Borrowing is blocked while unpaid fines exceed **20.00**. Blocked accounts may still use materials inside the library and the computing labs.

4.4 Waivers

Fines may be waived for a documented medical emergency or bereavement. Students should submit form **LIB-F7** to the service desk within 30 days of the item's return.

5. Computing Labs

5.1 Locations and equipment

- **Lab RM-204**: 40 Linux workstations with NVIDIA GPUs, intended for machine learning and graphics coursework.
- **Lab RM-118**: 60 Windows workstations with the standard teaching software.
- **Room RM-009**: assistive technology room (see section 8).

5.2 Opening hours

Labs are open **08:00 to 22:00** on weekdays and **10:00 to 18:00** at weekends. During the examination period weekday hours are extended to midnight.

5.3 Booking

Workstations can be booked through the student portal. Each student may book at most **two hours per day** and at most **three bookings per week**. A booking is released to other students if it is not claimed within **15 minutes** of its start time.

6. Acceptable Use

6.1 Prohibited activities

Lab computers may not be used for cryptocurrency mining, for sharing accounts or passwords, or for installing unlicensed software. Food is not permitted in the labs; drinks are allowed only in sealed containers.

6.2 Printing

Undergraduates receive a quota of **300 pages** of black-and-white printing per semester. Colour printing, and printing beyond the quota, is charged at 0.20 per page.

6.3 Long-running GPU jobs

Interactive sessions on the RM-204 GPUs are limited to four hours. Jobs expected to run longer than **four hours** must be submitted to the **long-gpu** batch queue instead of being run interactively:

```
labjob submit --queue long-gpu --gpus 1 train.py
labjob status
```

Jobs on the long-gpu queue may run for up to 48 hours.

7. Group Study Rooms

Group study rooms seat two to eight people and can be booked up to **seven days** in advance for a maximum of three hours at a time. Level 3 of the main library is a silent floor; group work is not permitted there.

8. Accessibility

Every lab workstation has the NVDA screen reader installed. Room RM-009 provides adjustable-height desks, screen magnifiers and a braille embosser, and can be booked by students registered with the disability service.

9. Breaches of This Policy

A first breach results in a written warning. A second breach results in a **two-week suspension** of lab access. A third breach is referred to the student conduct office.

10. Contact

The library help desk can be reached on extension 4420 during opening hours.